



Early signs: Arvid was marked out as a potential future star by Red Bull since he was 12 years old. GETTYIMAGES

am fully prepared. Maybe I am not 100 per cent ready.

But I am very used to being thrown in at the deep end. Every year, I have been pushed into a new category. I am used to being in this position and having to figure things out quickly.

How significant has the Red Bull

Junior Programme been, particularly your relationship with former head Dr Helmut Marko?

I joined the programme at the end of 2020, so this was my fifth year in it. They have played a huge role in developing me into the driver I am today. I did my first two years in karting, so when I moved into single-seaters, it was really through the programme.

I would not have been able to make these steps without the guidance, knowledge and expertise of people like Dr Helmut Marko and

Rocky (Guillaume Rocquelin). I have a very good relationship with Dr Marko. We have always got along well.

It is funny because you hear stories about him being tough on some drivers. But with me, he has always been really good. We are very open with each other. I do not think either of us likes excuses. We just say things as they are. I have learnt a lot from him.

2025 was a breakthrough year, highlighted by your first FP1

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If you could choose any teammate from any era, who would it be?

I really enjoyed working with Nikola (Tsolov) during the last two races in F2, so I would love to spend more time with him as a teammate.

One F1 rule you would change?

Maybe DRS from Lap 1.

Do you play video games?

Not much. I spend more time on the sim, but I have recently got into skateboarding. I am really enjoying the new Tony Hawk game.